Dark Touch — Open Questions

Decisions still to make for the Dark Touch GDD. Tick an item when it is decided, then move the decision into the GDD or its companion documents.

Combat and abilities

- [ ] New names for Deathbolt and Death Nova (all other names are final).
- [ ] The two variants of each ability.
- [ ] Whether aimed abilities get a soft-targeting assist or stay raw aim (decided during prototyping).
- [ ] Power of Below: duration, cooldown, how it is unlocked.
- [ ] The AoE rotation beyond Death Nova, and how talismans change the rotation.
- [ ] Which variant passives give Spirit, and how much.
- [ ] How many Souls a kill gives, and how many a Reap gives.
- [ ] Other stun sources, beyond the Mage’s charged spell and the Blademaster’s parry; can the player stun enemies?
- [ ] Splinters cone: its length; does it give 1 Soul per cast or per enemy hit?

Army and soldiers

- [ ] Player abilities granted by Mages, Rogues and Berserkers.
- [ ] Berserker: targeting priority, leap range and Whirlwind details.
- [ ] Grade and rank odds per difficulty tier.
- [ ] Is the collection at the base limited in size?
- [ ] Later: the special capture mechanic (a rhythm mini-game aligning auras, or another idea).
- [ ] Can a fallen soldier be revived during combat, or only once the section is clear?

Enemies and level

- [ ] Enemy roster for the level: which types appear, how often, how many elites.
- [ ] The boss of the level: design and mechanics (idea: adds spawning mid-fight to switch between single target and AoE).
- [ ] Level layout: how many sections, their size and shape, what marks the exit of a section, hidden chest placement, run length for the one-level demo.

Progression

- [ ] Talismans: stats they boost, rarity, how many can be owned, whether found ones are kept after a death; the drop rate once fight sizes are known (target: 2–3 per completed run).
- [ ] The experience curve: how much experience a run gives and how much each level needs.
- [ ] The talent list, including talents that change how Souls are gained.
- [ ] What each variant does.
- [ ] Tuning the Rank Odds board (enemies per fight, rank and grade odds) in playtests.

Presentation

- [ ] The mantle: light physics on its back strips, or stiff skinning only?
- [ ] Enemy health bars: exactly how the rank colour shows (bar fill or frame), whether the name is shown, and when they are visible without Alt (always, in combat, or only the target).
- [ ] Music: how much phonk to blend in, and in which layers.
- [ ] UI: screen order, and the UI Designer’s model.
- [ ] Default assignment of the 18 key slots (12 spells, 3 golden-slot abilities, 3 command-group keys) and of the 3 orders on the order bar.
- [ ] Accessibility options, such as reducing camera shake.
- [ ] Lore beyond the opening story: the entity, the war, the factions.

Balance

- [ ] All numbers: damage, HP, cooldowns, cast times, Reap buff values, talisman boosts.